Taking a model into an air-gapped network breaks three quiet assumptions

For product teams asked to run AI on a customer's own hardware

Three things reach for the internet without asking

01 **Packages and weights downloaded at runtime**

Loaders fetch what they need on the first run. Behind an air gap, that run fails.

02 **Tokenizers fetched on first use**

The tokenizer can be its own download on first load.

03 **Telemetry calling home**

Usage reporting tries to reach a vendor. Switch it off before handover.

Two things broke on a shared research cluster

01 **Compute nodes with no internet**

In our KittenTTS-indic fine-tune, the GPU nodes could not reach the internet. The model had to load from paths we staged first.

02 **A 3.5 GB file that would not memory-map**

Memory-mapping the safetensors file failed with ENOMEM, so the loader needed another way in.

Our rule: nothing calls out at runtime

> **Weights, tokenizers and dependencies are staged and verified before they cross into the air-gapped network.**

What does your model download the first time it runs?

We take models on-prem and into air-gapped networks, and keep them running after handover.

contact@hopline.co